

BTA ANALYTICS

Monthly Partner In- sights Report

Feb 2026

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Monthly Highlights

The perceived value and advocacy for the BTA platform are demonstrating a consistently positive trend across various cohorts and regions. The overall platform advocacy NPS (net promoter score for the BTA training platform itself) for all cohorts increased **28.8 points** in January 2026, reaching a strong score of 89.2. This positive momentum has continued into the current quarter, with platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts rising moderately by 22.1 points to 86.7 during Jan–Feb QTD. Similarly, budtenders' platform advocacy NPS saw a moderate increase of 26.7 points to 83.9, and for Ontario respondents, it increased moderately by 20.3 points to 84.3 during the same QTD period. These recent scores consistently surpass the all-time average platform advocacy NPS of 80.3, signalling strong engagement with BTA resources.

DATA Data: Overall platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (Jan 2026 MoM) = +28.8 pts

DATA Data: Overall platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (Jan 2026) = 89.2 (Strong)

DATA Data: Overall platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (QTD average) = +22.1 pts

DATA Data: Overall platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (QTD average) = 86.7 (Strong)

DATA Data: Budtenders' platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = +26.7 pts

DATA Data: Budtenders' platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = 83.9 (Strong)

DATA Data: Ontario platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = +20.3 pts

DATA Data: Ontario platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = 84.3 (Strong)

DATA Data: All-time average platform advocacy NPS = 80.3 (Strong)

BTA platform advocacy shows strong, consistent growth across all metrics.

Early signals suggest significant shifts in customer experience feedback and stated loyalty drivers, though these require careful interpretation due to small sample sizes. Early signal: Among BC respondents, the proportion mentioning reacting to a negative experience by telling friends or posting online fell sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17), indicating a reduced propensity for public negative feedback. Concurrently, Early signal: the suggestion of rewards programs to improve experience also decreased sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) in BC, aligning with Early signal: a sharp decline of 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) in mentions of 'Rewards or loyalty points' as a driver for returning to a store. In Ontario, Early signal: mentions of 'Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it' as a positive memorable experience decreased sharply by 93.8 points (dir.; N=16). These observations are based on small sample sizes (N between 16 and 17) and should be interpreted with caution, as changes derived from such small bases can be unreliable.

DATA Data: BC respondents mentioning reacting to a negative experience by telling friends or posting online (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents suggesting rewards programs to improve experience (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents mentioning 'Rewards or loyalty points' as a return driver (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: Ontario respondents mentioning 'Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it' as a positive memorable experience (MoM) = -93.8 pts (N=16)

While platform advocacy NPS demonstrates strong performance, the overall NPS for the broader respondent base presents a different picture, indicating room for market-wide improvements. The overall NPS score for Jan-Feb QTD moderately increased by 22.3 points to a competitive 56.3. For budtenders, the NPS score sharply increased by 34.2 points to 41.9, though this remains in the weak category (dir.; N=31 for QTD aggregate). In Ontario, NPS moderately increased by 27.4 points to a competitive 50.0 (dir.; N=34 for QTD aggregate). These QTD scores remain notably below the platform advocacy NPS, which ranges from 83.9 to 89.2. This gap could indicate: (1) that the BTA platform itself is highly valued and performing well, but general customer experience with the broader market or specific retail services still has room for improvement; (2) a difference in the respondent groups for each NPS, with platform users potentially more engaged; or (3) that the questions capture different aspects of satisfaction, with platform-specific interactions garnering higher favourability than overall market experiences. It is also important to note that the NPS scores for Budtenders (N=31) and Ontario (N=34) in Jan-Feb QTD are based on samples under 50, meaning these trends should be interpreted with caution.

DATA Data: Overall NPS (QTD average) = +22.3 pts

DATA Data: Overall NPS (QTD average) = 56.3 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Budtenders NPS (QTD average) = +34.2 pts (N=31)

DATA Data: Budtenders NPS (QTD average) = 41.9 (Weak)

DATA Data: Ontario NPS (QTD average) = +27.4 pts (N=34)

DATA Data: Ontario NPS (QTD average) = 50.0 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = 83.9–89.2 (Strong)

So what for retailers: Retail managers should leverage the strong BTA platform advocacy by encouraging staff to engage with BTA resources for continuous learning and professional development. Concurrently, investigate if current loyalty programs or customer feedback channels effectively capture and address evolving consumer preferences, especially in BC and Ontario, to narrow the gap between platform satisfaction and overall market experience.

Panel Overview

Cannabis retailers should interpret month-over-month comparisons with caution, as current data signals potential shifts in respondent behaviour or survey participation patterns, impacting the stability of monthly comparability. The observed sharp declines across various response categories, particularly within specific regions, are derived from very small sample sizes. This context requires that these findings be interpreted with caution, as the delta values are unreliable due to the limited number of participants. Shifting panel demographics challenge stable month-over-month comparisons.

EARLY SIGNAL In British Columbia, the inclination of respondents to “Mention the experience to friends or online” following a negative encounter fell sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to approximately 5.9% since last month. Similarly, Early signal: the perceived importance of “Rewards or loyalty points” as a key driver for returning to a store also saw a substantial decrease of 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to approximately 5.9% among BC respondents. In Ontario, Early signal: the proportion of respondents identifying “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience sharply declined by 93.8 points (dir.; N=16) to approximately 6.3%. These substantial shifts, while indicative of potential changes in respondent sentiment or priorities, also highlight challenges for establishing stable month-over-month comparisons due to the fluctuating nature of responses from small groups. This pattern could indicate a shift in the demographics or psychographics of the monthly respondent pool, changes in how respondents interpret or engage with specific survey questions, or an unusual data collection period.

DATA Data: BC respondents indicating “Mention the experience to friends or online” after a negative encounter (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents indicating “Rewards or loyalty points” as a key return driver (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: Ontario respondents identifying “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience (MoM) = -93.8 pts (N=16)

So what for retailers: Given the directional nature of these shifts, BTA partners in BC and Ontario should focus on diversifying feedback collection methods beyond general surveys and monitor evolving customer engagement directly at the store level. District managers should discuss these localized trends with their teams to identify if these signals align with anecdotal observations.

Category Trends

In British Columbia, there’s an early signal of a significant re-evaluation of loyalty programs and a reduced propensity for customers to share negative experiences publicly. Early signal: The proportion of BC respondents who would mention a negative experience to friends or online fell sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to approximately 5.9% this month, suggesting a shift in how negative feedback is managed or expressed. Early signal: Similarly, the stated preference for specific rewards programs, described as “a rewards program with rewards Not 11% off between 9am & 11am,” decreased sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to approximately 5.9% as an improvement suggestion. Furthermore, Early

signal: the importance of “Rewards or loyalty points” as a driver for returning to a store also fell sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to approximately 5.9%. These significant shifts, while based on an unreliable delta from a small sample size, suggest a re-evaluation of how consumers engage with and are motivated by retail store experiences in BC.

DATA Data: BC respondents mentioning a negative experience to friends or online (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents preferring a specific rewards program as an improvement suggestion (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents citing “Rewards or loyalty points” as a return driver (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

BC customers show reduced engagement with traditional loyalty and public negative feedback.

Early signals in Ontario suggest that personalized budtender interaction may be less frequently cited as a defining aspect of a positive memorable experience. Early signal: Among Ontario respondents, the recognition of “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience decreased sharply by 93.8 points (dir.; N=16) to approximately 6.3% this month. This suggests consumers may be finding other aspects of the retail experience more memorable or that the emphasis on this particular interaction type has waned. This delta is unreliable due to the small sample size.

DATA Data: Ontario respondents recognizing “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience (MoM) = -93.8 pts (N=16)

So what for retailers: Store managers in BC should reassess the effectiveness of existing loyalty programs and explore alternative strategies for customer retention and feedback collection. In Ontario, retail staff should consider broadening their approach to customer experience, recognizing that memorable interactions may now extend beyond direct product recommendations to other elements like store atmosphere, product availability, or efficient service.

Emerging Preferences

Across the market, early signals suggest a move away from explicit loyalty programs as primary return drivers and a reduction in publicly shared negative feedback. Early signal: In British Columbia, the stated importance of “Rewards or loyalty points” as a driver to return to a store sharply decreased by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to 5.9% this month. Similarly, Early signal: the suggestion for “a rewards program with rewards Not 11% off between 9am & 11am” as an experience improvement also fell sharply by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to 5.9%. These trends, based on small samples (N=17), should be interpreted with caution as the deltas may be unreliable. Concurrently, Early signal: the tendency for respondents in British Columbia to “Mention the experience to friends or online” regarding negative experiences sharply declined by 94.1 points (dir.; N=17) to 5.9%, also based on a small sample (N=17) with an unreliable delta. In Ontario, Early signal: the perception of “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience also sharply declined by 93.8 points (dir.; N=16) to 6.3%. This observation, from a small sample (N=16), should likewise be interpreted with caution due to an unreliable delta.

DATA Data: BC respondents stating importance of “Rewards or loyalty points” as a return driver (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents suggesting “a rewards program with rewards Not 11% off between 9am & 11am” for improvement (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: BC respondents tending to “Mention the experience to friends or online” for negative experiences (MoM) = -94.1 pts (N=17)

DATA Data: Ontario respondents perceiving “Listening to my questions and suggesting a good product based off it” as a positive memorable experience (MoM) = -93.8 pts (N=16)

Loyalty programs and public negative feedback show early signs of declining impact.

Despite shifts in specific preferences, broader market indices for overall friction, choice friction, and experience quality remain stable and competitive. The overall friction index saw a marginal increase of **0.6 points** to 74.1, positioning it as competitive. Conversely, the Choice Friction Index (a composite of ease-of-decision and selection confidence) marginally decreased by 1.1 points to 55.4, also remaining competitive. The experience quality index marginally decreased by 0.5 points to 81.1, continuing to demonstrate strong performance. Furthermore, the decision context index marginally decreased by 0.3 points to 58.0, and the Brand Trust Index (a measure of consumer confidence in cannabis brands) marginally increased by 0.3 points to 66.7, with both indices residing within the competitive band.

DATA Data: Overall friction index (MoM) = +0.6 pts

DATA Data: Overall friction index = 74.1 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Choice Friction Index (MoM) = -1.1 pts

DATA Data: Choice Friction Index = 55.4 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Experience quality index (MoM) = -0.5 pts

DATA Data: Experience quality index = 81.1 (Strong)

DATA Data: Decision context index (MoM) = -0.3 pts

DATA Data: Decision context index = 58.0 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Brand Trust Index (MoM) = +0.3 pts

DATA Data: Brand Trust Index = 66.7 (Competitive)

So what for retailers: Retail managers should monitor these emerging preference shifts to adapt customer engagement strategies. While core experience quality remains strong, a declining reliance on

traditional loyalty programs and public negative feedback channels suggests opportunities to innovate in customer retention and in-store issue resolution, maintaining low friction and high trust.

Learning & Engagement Gaps

Learning & Development Engagement

Younger budtenders (19-24) show a positive trend in perceived employer support for learning and career development, contrasting with a decline among older staff (55+). Among the 19-24 age group, the percentage of respondents who disagree with having opportunities to continue learning on the job fell sharply by **83.3 points** to approximately 16.7%. Similarly, the proportion of this age group who strongly disagree that their employer invests in their long-term career development decreased sharply by 83.3 points to approximately 16.7%. This suggests a positive trajectory where younger employees perceive more support for their professional growth. However, this trend is not uniform across all demographics; for respondents aged 55+, the percentage agreeing that their employer encourages them to attend industry events or training decreased sharply by 80.0 points to approximately 20.0%, indicating a potential disparity in employer-provided development opportunities for older staff.

DATA Data: 19-24 age group respondents disagreeing with learning opportunities (MoM) = -83.3 pts

DATA Data: 19-24 age group respondents strongly disagreeing that employer invests in long-term career development (MoM) = -83.3 pts

DATA Data: 55+ age group respondents agreeing employer encourages industry events/training (MoM) = -80.0 pts

Employer support for younger budtender development shows positive momentum, while older staff perceive less.

Among younger budtenders (19-24), there are significant shifts in how they engage with external brand representatives and the value they place on traditional brand materials. Among the 19-24 age group, the proportion indicating monthly representative visits decreased sharply by 83.3 points to approximately 16.7% this month. In parallel, the value placed on “Brand/Product Brochures Materials” by this same age group decreased sharply by 83.3 points to approximately 16.7%. These shifts could contribute to broader market trends, with the Early signal: Interaction Coverage Index (proportion of respondents reporting substantive budtender engagement) for budtenders decreasing marginally by 4.8 points, and the overall interaction coverage index also decreasing marginally by 4.1 points. Early signal: The Recommendation Conversion Index (share of interactions that resulted in a product recommendation being made) across all roles also saw a marginal decrease of 4.5 points, suggesting that reduced engagement with traditional representative visits and materials might impact the efficacy of product recommendations.

DATA Data: 19-24 age group respondents indicating monthly representative visits (MoM) = -83.3 pts

DATA Data: 19-24 age group respondents valuing “Brand/Product Brochures Materials” (MoM) = -83.3 pts

DATA Data: Budtenders Interaction Coverage Index (MoM) = -4.8 pts

DATA Data: Overall interaction coverage index (MoM) = -4.1 pts

DATA Data: Recommendation Conversion Index across all roles (MoM) = -4.5 pts

While the overall quality of customer-facing interactions remains strong, there's a potential gap emerging between the perceived depth of knowledge and confidence in decision-making, possibly linked to declining engagement with traditional learning sources. In the 45-54 age group, the percentage of respondents who selected a specific high-confidence response for the 'knowledge vs. decision' metric decreased sharply by 75.0 points to approximately 25.0%. Despite these shifts and the marginal declines in interaction and conversion metrics, the all-time average score for the experience quality index across all roles remains strong at approximately 81.6%. This suggests that while the **quality** of individual interactions is perceived as high, the **frequency** or **breadth** of these interactions may be insufficient to maintain overall coverage. Additionally, while the core experience is positive, it is not consistently translating into actionable recommendations at the same rate, and the declining engagement with traditional learning sources might be eroding confidence in broader decision-making capabilities without significantly impacting the perceived quality of customer-facing interactions.

DATA Data: 45-54 age group respondents selecting high-confidence response for 'knowledge vs. decision' (MoM) = -75.0 pts

DATA Data: All-time average experience quality index across all roles = 81.6 (Strong)

So what for retailers: Head buyers and store managers should review current learning and development programs to ensure they are engaging for all age groups, potentially modernizing delivery methods for younger staff and reaffirming support for experienced employees. Consider how product knowledge is being disseminated and reinforced, as declining interaction coverage could impact recommendation confidence and conversion if not addressed.

Sentiment & Advocacy

Overall sentiment and loyalty indicators for the industry have shown a positive upward trend, driven by strong growth in Net Promoter Score. The overall Net Promoter Score (NPS) for the industry increased moderately by **22.3 points** in Jan-Feb QTD, reaching a competitive score of 56.3. This places the current NPS 22.3 points higher than the all-time average of 34.0. Reinforcing this positive trend, the platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts also saw a moderate increase of 22.1 points in Jan-Feb QTD, building on a similar moderate rise of 28.8 points observed since last month in January 2026.

DATA Data: Overall NPS (QTD average) = +22.3 pts

DATA Data: Overall NPS (QTD average) = 56.3 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Overall NPS (QTD average) = +22.3 pts vs all-time average

DATA Data: All-time average NPS = 34.0 (Weak)

DATA Data: Platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (QTD average) = +22.1 pts

DATA Data: Platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts (Jan 2026 MoM) = +28.8 pts

Industry sentiment and platform advocacy continue their positive trajectory.

This improving emotional climate is also reflected within specific cohorts, with both budtenders and Ontario respondents showing increased advocacy. Early signal: Among budtenders, the Net Promoter Score increased moderately by 34.2 points to 41.9 in Jan–Feb QTD (dir.; N=31). This score represents a substantial increase of 34.2 points compared to the all-time average of 7.7 for this group (N=52). Similarly, Early signal: the Ontario province segment experienced a moderate rise of 27.4 points in NPS, achieving a score of 50.0 in Jan–Feb QTD (dir.; N=34). Concurrent with these NPS movements, platform advocacy among the budtender role cohort rose moderately by 26.7 points in Jan–Feb QTD, and the Ontario province cohort also showed a moderate increase of 20.3 points in platform advocacy NPS during the same quarter.

DATA Data: Budtenders NPS (QTD average) = +34.2 pts (N=31)

DATA Data: Budtenders NPS (QTD average) = 41.9 (Weak)

DATA Data: Budtenders NPS vs all-time average (N=52) = +34.2 pts

DATA Data: Ontario NPS (QTD average) = +27.4 pts (N=34)

DATA Data: Ontario NPS (QTD average) = 50.0 (Competitive)

DATA Data: Budtender role platform advocacy (QTD average) = +26.7 pts

DATA Data: Ontario province platform advocacy NPS (QTD average) = +20.3 pts

While overall industry NPS sits at a competitive level, there appears to be a stronger inclination toward advocating for the BTA platform itself, indicating a distinct value proposition. The all-time average platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts stands at a strong 80.3, which is notably higher than the Jan–Feb QTD overall NPS of 56.3. This gap suggests that users perceive specific value in the platform’s utility or features that elicits higher advocacy than the broader organizational experience. The platform fosters a more direct and positive interaction that encourages recommendation, or different emotional connections are driving general sentiment versus direct platform endorsement. The all-time average Brand Trust Index, at 66.4, aligns more closely with the overall NPS, suggesting that trust in the brand and advocacy for the platform might operate on slightly different mechanisms.

DATA Data: All-time average platform advocacy NPS for all cohorts = 80.3 (Strong)

DATA Data: Q1 2026 overall NPS = 56.3 (Competitive)

DATA Data: All-time average Brand Trust Index = 66.4 (Competitive)

So what for retailers: BTA partners should recognize the BTA platform as a powerful tool for fostering positive sentiment and advocacy among their staff. Consider how to translate the high satisfaction with BTA’s platform into broader positive sentiment for their retail operations by integrating BTA insights into training and customer service protocols.

Monthly Implications

Platform advocacy continues to demonstrate a positive trajectory, with overall NPS scores for all cohorts, budtenders, and Ontario consistently above the all-time average during Jan–Feb QTD and January 2026. Conversely, early signals suggest potential localized shifts in consumer engagement and priorities, which warrant careful interpretation due to the reliance on very small sample sizes and unreliable delta values. Early signal: In British Columbia, there is an indicated re-evaluation of loyalty programs and the propensity for public negative feedback, evidenced by sharply decreased importance of “Rewards or loyalty points” as a return driver and a reduced inclination to share negative experiences (dir.; N=17). Concurrently, Early signal: in Ontario, the emphasis on personalized budtender interaction as a defining aspect of a positive memorable experience appears to have waned (dir.; N=16), potentially indicating other elements of the retail experience are becoming more impactful. Despite these specific localized shifts, broader market indices for friction, experience quality, and brand trust remain stable, with overall friction, choice friction, decision context, and brand trust indices within competitive ranges, and the experience quality index continuing to perform strongly, albeit with marginal shifts.

So what for retailers: Store managers should actively solicit feedback on customer experience and loyalty program effectiveness in their local markets, especially in BC and Ontario, to stay ahead of these emerging trends. Head buyers may want to revisit the value proposition of current loyalty offerings, while district managers should encourage a holistic view of the customer journey, moving beyond a singular focus on direct budtender recommendations to encompass all touchpoints that contribute to a positive retail experience.

Methodology & Data Quality

Data Source

This report draws on survey data collected through the **BTA (Budtenders Association)** platform. All respondents are verified, active budtenders enrolled in the BTA training ecosystem. Survey participation is opt-in and occurs as part of ongoing training and assessment cycles.

Respondent Verification

Respondents are authenticated through BTA’s enrolment and session-tracking system. Only respondents with verified budtender status at a licensed retail cannabis location are included in segment-level analyses.

Confidence Tiers and N-Thresholds

All metrics and claims in this report are assigned a confidence tier based on the number of qualifying respondents (N) in the relevant segment or period:

Tier	N Threshold	Interpretation
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High Confidence	$N \geq 30$	Stable, reportable finding
Directional	$15 \leq N < 30$	Early signal; treat with caution
Suppressed	$N < 15$	Not reported (insufficient data)

Claims marked **Directional** are prefaced with “Early signal:” throughout this report. Suppressed data is excluded from all outputs.

Comparison Windows

- **Quarterly reports:** Primary comparison is to the immediately preceding quarter (QoQ). An all-time baseline is used for contextual anchoring where available.
- **Monthly reports:** Primary comparison is to the prior month (MoM). Quarter-to-date (QTD) aggregates are used where monthly N is insufficient.
- **Biannual reports:** Spring and Fall waves are compared to the prior equivalent wave (year-over-year cadence).

Index Construction

Composite indices (e.g., Brand Health Index, Choice Friction Index) are calculated using pre-defined question batteries and scoring rubrics maintained in the BTA Question Bank.

Quality Assurance Steps

1. **Duplicate response removal:** Each respondent-period combination is deduplicated before analysis.
2. **Outlier review:** Extreme response distributions are flagged for human review before claim generation.
3. **Directional consistency check:** Claims where the stated direction contradicts the underlying magnitude are automatically flagged as `direction_mismatch`.
4. **Orphan reference check:** Claims referencing question IDs not present in the underlying evidence packet are flagged as `orphan_reference`.
5. **Human review gate:** Any report with a readiness score below 0.70 or with unresolved directional mismatch flags requires analyst sign-off before distribution.

Limitations

- This report reflects the perceptions and behaviours of BTA-enrolled budtenders and does not represent the broader cannabis retail workforce.
- Response rates vary by segment and period; lower-N periods may reflect seasonal variation or enrolment fluctuations rather than true attitude shifts.
- All findings are observational. No causal inferences should be drawn from this data.

Next Month Watch

Next month's themes will focus on validating several early signals suggesting potential shifts in consumer behaviour and sentiment, particularly within British Columbia and Ontario. There is an emerging trend indicating a re-evaluation of loyalty programs and rewards as primary drivers for store returns, alongside a reduced propensity for consumers to publicly share negative experiences. Concurrently, attributes defining a positive memorable experience appear to be evolving, moving away from a singular focus on personalized budtender interactions in Ontario. These shifts, while substantial in magnitude, are derived from very small sample sizes, rendering the observed deltas unreliable.

Therefore, a key objective will be to monitor these specific indicators in the upcoming reporting period to ascertain if these initial observations represent sustained trends or statistical anomalies related to survey participation patterns or respondent demographics. Deeper investigation will aim to understand the underlying drivers should these shifts prove durable, impacting strategies for customer retention, feedback collection, and experience design.

So what for retailers: Prepare to observe and analyze customer feedback and transaction data in the coming month, specifically looking for consistency or deviation in loyalty program engagement and preferred customer service interactions. Consider implementing small-scale, localized pilots based on these early signals to gather preliminary insights before broader strategic adjustments.

How to Use This Report

Intended Audience

This report is prepared exclusively for **BTA partners** and cannabis retail professionals. It is intended for internal strategic use by retail management and buying teams at their respective organizations.

Usage Permissions

-  Internal strategic planning and decision-making
-  Sharing with senior leadership and board-level stakeholders under NDA
-  Informing retail education program development
-  Benchmarking internal KPIs against directional industry signals

Restrictions

-  **Do not distribute** this report externally, including to retailers not directly affiliated with your organization, dispensaries, press, or research institutions, without explicit written consent from BTA
-  **Do not publish** any figures, charts, or excerpts from this report in public-facing materials, social media, or press releases
-  **Do not attribute** claims in this report to named individuals, specific stores, or specific retail chains
-  **Do not use** this report to make employment, compensation, or performance decisions about individual budtenders

Interpreting Findings Responsibly

Directional Claims Are Early Signals

Claims marked “Early signal:” are based on 15–29 respondents in the relevant segment or period. These findings represent directional patterns that may or may not persist as sample sizes grow. They should be treated as hypotheses for further investigation, not confirmed truths.

No Causal Claims

This report describes correlational patterns in survey data. The presence of a segment in the survey panel, a change in awareness scores, or a shift in recommendation rates does not *cause* those outcomes — it reflects reported perceptions at a point in time. Do not use this data to make causal claims in marketing materials.

Individual-Level Inferences Are Not Supported

All metrics are aggregated across the respondent pool. It is not possible to identify, characterise, or make inferences about any individual budtender from this data.

Competitive Data Is Contextual Only

Where competitive context is provided, segment names or market positions are presented in aggregate or anonymised form. This data is not intended for direct competitive comparison in sales pitches or procurement conversations.

Data Retention and Confidentiality

Recipients are responsible for ensuring that this report is stored and handled in accordance with their organization's data governance policies. BTA recommends restricting access to personnel with a direct need for the insights contained herein.

Questions and Escalation

For questions about methodology, data interpretation, or permitted uses of this report, contact your BTA Partner Success representative.

Report Metadata

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Generated by the BTA Analytics pipeline. See the Methodology & Controls section for data quality details.